

Document 3: Global Strategy & Valuation Brief

Purpose: To justify a premium valuation based on global tailwinds and industrial demand.

OPTIQAI GLOBAL STRATEGY: THE SEMICONDUCTOR TRIFECTA

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1. MARKET CONTEXT: THE 2026 "INTERCONNECT" WALL The Silicon Photonics market is projected to hit **\$3.5B in 2026** (25% CAGR), driven by the move from 800G to **1.6T transceivers** in AI data centers. Traditional design tools are failing this transition. OptiqAI is the "Design Multiplier" that ensures the global chip supply chain meets this demand.

2. THE THREE-PILLAR STRATEGY (GEO-ARBITRAGE)

-  **USA: The Capital & Intelligence Engine**
 - **Action:** Incorporate in Delaware to access US risk capital (a16z, Sequoia).
 - **Goal:** Serve as the "System of Record" for US-based hyperscalers (Meta, Amazon, Google) building custom AI ASICs with optical I/O.
-  **EUROPE: The R&D & Sovereignty Fortress**
 - **Action:** Leverage the **EU Chips Act 2.0 (€43B+)** and photonics hubs like IMEC.
 - **Goal:** Position OptiqAI as the "Sovereign EDA" solution for Europe's industrial autonomy, accessing non-dilutive grants (EIC/Horizon) unavailable to pure US startups.
-  **INDIA: The Scaled Fabrication Frontier**
 - **Action:** Align with the **India Semiconductor Mission (ISM) 2.0**.
 - **Goal:** Provide the native software stack for the 85,000+ engineers being trained in India's new 3nm/2nm fab ecosystems (Tata/Micron). We are the "Brain" for India's "Manufacturing Body."

3. VALUATION THESIS (SEED STAGE) In 2026, AI-native deep tech commands a **42% valuation premium**. We are targeting a seed-round valuation based on the following:

- **The "Simulation Tax" Savings:** Our 18,000x speedup saves an estimated **\$100k per engineer/year** in wasted compute and salary time.
- **Design Velocity:** We reduce "Time-to-Tapeout" for custom ASICs from 18 months to 9 months.
- **Target Raise: \$2.5M - \$4M** at a post-money valuation of **\$18M - \$22M** (standard for 2026 high-conviction AI-Infrastructure leaders).

4. 6-MONTH MILESTONES

- **Month 2:** 3 Design Partners secured (1 US Hyperscaler, 1 EU Lab, 1 Indian Fab).
- **Month 4:** Integration of foundry PDKs (Process Design Kits) for 220nm SOI.

- **Month 6:** Fully agentic design workflow (Text-to-GDSII).